

5. Trigonometry

What students need to learn:

The sine and cosine rules, and the area of a triangle in the form $\frac{1}{2}ab \sin C$.

Radian measure, including use for arc length and area of sector.

Sine, cosine and tangent functions. Their graphs, symmetries and periodicity.

Knowledge and use of $\tan \theta = \frac{\sin \theta}{\cos \theta}$, and $\sin^2 \theta + \cos^2 \theta = 1$.

Solution of simple trigonometric equations in a given interval.

Use of the formulae $s = r\theta$ and $A = \frac{1}{2}r^2\theta$ for a circle.

Knowledge of graphs of curves with equations such as $y = 3 \sin x$, $y = \sin\left(x + \frac{\pi}{6}\right)$, $y = \sin 2x$ is expected.

Students should be able to solve equations such as

$$\sin\left(x + \frac{\pi}{2}\right) = \frac{3}{4} \text{ for } 0 < x < 2\pi,$$

$$\cos(x + 30^\circ) = \frac{1}{2} \text{ for } -180^\circ < x < 180^\circ,$$

$$\tan 2x = 1 \text{ for } 90^\circ < x < 270^\circ,$$

$$6 \cos^2 x + \sin x - 5 = 0 \text{ for } 0^\circ \leq x < 360^\circ,$$

$$\sin^2\left(x + \frac{\pi}{6}\right) = \frac{1}{2} \text{ for } -\pi \leq x < \pi.$$
